ryanjpals@gmail.com
(319) 930-2308
linkedin.com/in/rjpals
github.com/rjpals

Ryan Pals

EXPERIENCE

Frontend Developer Jan 2024 – Present
Breach Secure Now · Remote

- Delivered features across a 1M+ user security awareness platform — including a Microsoft Teams tab app — spanning React, Python/Flask, and AWS Lambda, expanding scope beyond frontend title into full-stack delivery
- Built an internal DAM integrating the Brandfolder API, cutting asset selection latency 93% (700ms → 50ms) through targeted memoization and render optimization
- Resolved an unsupported MUI v4/v5 style engine conflict (JSS vs Emotion) in a production Teams application, unblocking a major feature workstream with no vendor documentation to rely on
- Served as primary liaison between engineering, design, and product — establishing Figma handoff standards for an offshore design team and contributing to frontend hiring decisions

AI Training Contractor Feb 2023 – Dec 2023
DataAnnotation.tech · Remote

Frontend Developer 2 Mar 2022 – Feb 2023
Zesty.io · Remote

- Led TypeScript adoption across a 4M+ SLOC React/JavaScript codebase, designing an incremental migration plan that avoided disrupting a 5-person active engineering team
- Migrated legacy SASS design system to MUI CSS-in-JS, establishing new component and styling conventions across the platform
- Redesigned core user experiences including a digital asset manager, global search, and primary navigation

Software Engineer Feb 2019 – Mar 2022
Hobu, Inc · Iowa City, IA

- Rewrote a React/OpenLayers GIS application for National Geospatial-Intelligence Agency and DOD analysts, delivering a modernized geospatial intelligence tool for a classified user base
- Contributed shader optimizations to Potree, an open source WebGL/Three.js point cloud renderer, and authored new OBJ read/write modules for PDAL, both merged and adopted in production
- Built a 3D WebGL rendering application to support active glacier movement research (helheim.lidar.io)

SKILLS

Languages	TypeScript/JavaScript, Python, Bash
Frontend	React, Redux/RTK-Query, Material UI, Next.js, WebGL/Three.js, OpenLayers, Tailwind CSS
Testing/Tooling	Cypress, Sentry.io, Docker, GNU/Linux, vim
Backend	Python/Flask, AWS Lambda, Supabase/Postgres, SQLite

EDUCATION

Iowa State University Aug 2015 – Dec 2018
B.S. Computer Engineering

- Cumulative GPA 3.35 · Junior/Senior GPA 3.72
- Supplemental Focus Area in Cybersecurity